

TAKAO UMEHARA

TAH-kah-oh oo-meh-HAH-rah

Principal Product Designer & AI Product Builder · Creative Director · New Ventures

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01 SUMMARY

Designer-builder who ships AI products with Claude Code and Codex. At Verizon, built 10 AI agents into existing tools for 40+ designers and 80+ stakeholders after 16 hours of interviews, and trained 50+ designers and product partners. 20+ years of 0→1 product, brand, and experience work.

02 SELECTED AI PRODUCTS — designed and built with Claude Code / Codex

- **Intent First** — intentfirst.ai. Thesis and toolkit for agentic UX: products should start from user intent, not features. Its Context Grammar (intent, signals, dials, a rule engine, and a negotiation gate) decides when an agent should act, ask, or wait. Ships with a live intent parser.
- **Resona** — resonamotion.com. Gesture-to-music instrument: a camera reads body gesture via MediaPipe and turns movement into sound in real time, entirely on-device, with no video transmitted. Designed the interaction model and tuned the feedback loop.
- **moime** — Mobile link-in-bio builder. Show it a flyer and it reads the dates and codes to draft your page, so the first minute is spent reacting, not configuring.

03 SKILLS

AI prototyping: Claude Code, Codex, LLM/agent design, prompt design · **Input:** MediaPipe / camera & body input, multi-device and QR-based multiplayer · **Design:** Figma (expert), design systems, rapid prototyping, interaction & visual design · **Methods:** Break Bias ideation, research interviews, workshop facilitation

04 EXPERIENCE

creativity is everywhere — New York, NY

2006–Present

FOUNDER & CREATIVE DIRECTOR

Independent studio I founded in 2006, run alongside and between full-time roles. Recent work (2023–present):

- Design and build 0→1 AI products (**Intent First**, **Resona**, **moime**) hands-on with Claude Code and Codex.
- Led product and design for the **CLI Studios** app redesign, including a scalable cross-platform design system.
- Created **Break Bias**, a bilingual workshop method for challenging assumptions (Morinaga, HakuHodo, Olympus).

Verizon — New York, NY

2025–2026

LEAD PRODUCT DESIGNER, AI ENABLEMENT | CONTRACT

- Ran 16 hours of interviews on how designers actually worked, then **built 10 AI agents** into the tools 40+ designers and 80+ cross-functional stakeholders across six brands already used, in a highly restricted enterprise environment.
- **Built** a project-level “Master Brain” consolidating stakeholder input, research, domain knowledge, and meeting transcripts into a shared source of context.
- **Built** AI-assisted validation and edge-case workflows that surfaced usability issues, missing states, and downstream risks before engineering.
- **Trained and onboarded 50+** designers and product partners on practical AI-enabled workflows across Verizon’s prepaid portfolio.

Concentrix Catalyst — New York, NY

2021–2023

LEAD PRODUCT DESIGNER / DESIGN MANAGER

- **Managed and mentored 20+ designers** through product reviews, workshops, and hands-on design leadership.
- Led exploratory AI, AR, and VR concept work recognized with internal **Merit Awards for Generative AI and Metaverse** initiatives.
- Co-founded and led an Omnichannel Design Group uniting design, product, engineering, and marketing around connected customer experiences.
- Led early-stage concept development and rapid prototyping for enterprise and consumer experience initiatives.

ProjectEd — New York, NY

2015–2018

PRODUCT DESIGN LEAD / DESIGN STRATEGY LEAD

- Designed a research productivity platform for the **Carnegie Foundation**, contributing to a **25% increase in engagement**.
- Led the nationwide digital experience for the **XQ Institute** high-school redesign initiative, working with education leaders backed by Emerson Collective.
- Led product and design strategy for education and research platforms, translating complex institutional goals into usable digital experiences.

Amplify Education / Wireless Generation — New York, NY

2009–2015

PRODUCT DESIGN LEAD / DESIGN STRATEGIST

- Designed and launched **12+ learning products** across web, tablet, and mobile, including Amplify ELA Quests and early-literacy / assessment tools.
- Led 0→1 product design with engineers, playwrights, learning experts, and PMs to create immersive, mystery-driven classroom experiences.

Earlier: Ogilvy Brand Integration Group, Rockwell Group, Anomaly — brand, digital, and environmental work for Coca-Cola, IBM, Motorola; led UI design for Virgin America's in-flight entertainment.

05 COMMUNITY

- **Autumn Festival Reinvention**, Volunteer Creative & Experience Lead — rebuilt a post-COVID community festival around 11 original game experiences; game revenue grew 3x+ over three years.

06 TEACHING, WRITING & RECOGNITION

- Mentor at SVA and SOSV startup founder coaching · Co-author, **Extra Ordinary: An Amusing Guide for Unleashing Your Creativity** (2005) · Biz/Zine articles on creative thinking and cognitive bias · Writing on AI and intent at intentfirst.substack.com
- The One Show Design Merit Award (Motorola CeBIT) · American Graphic Design Award (DO!NUTS Tokyo) · Concentrix Merit Awards (Generative AI / Metaverse)

07 EDUCATION

- BFA, Graphic Design — ArtCenter College of Design
- BS, Policy Management — Keio University (SFC)
- Graduate Studies, Strategic Design & Management — Parsons School of Design
- Strategy in the Age of Digital Disruption (Online) — INSEAD